

Bandit Level 13 → Level 14

The next password cannot be read directly. Instead, **Bandit 13** provides an **SSH private key** that can be used to log in as **bandit14**.

Step 1: Find the private key

After logging in as **bandit13**, run:

`Ls -al`

You should find:

`Sshkey.private`

```
bandit13@bandit:~$ ls
HINT  sshkey.private
bandit13@bandit:~$ ls -al
total 28
drwxr-xr-x  2 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 150 root    root    4096 Jun 24 15:02 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     220 Feb 13  2026 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    3851 Jun 24 14:50 .bashrc
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     807 Feb 13  2026 .profile
-rw-r-----  1 bandit14 bandit13  467 Jun 24 14:59 HINT
-rw-r-----  1 bandit14 bandit13 2602 Jun 24 14:59 sshkey.private
bandit13@bandit:~$ |
```

Step 2: View the key

Run:

`cat sshkey.private`

You will see a long private key starting with:

-----BEGIN OPENSSH PRIVATE KEY-----

and ending with:

-----END OPENSSH PRIVATE KEY-----

Copy the **entire key**.

Step 3: Save the key on your computer

First exit Bandit 13:

exit

In Windows, create a file named:

sshkey.private

Paste the complete private key into it.

Make sure the file is not saved as `sshkey.private.txt`

```

bandit13@bandit:~$ ls
HINT  sshkey.private
bandit13@bandit:~$ cat sshkey.private
-----BEGIN OPENSSH PRIVATE KEY-----
b3BlbnNzaC1rZXktdjEAAAABAG5vbmUAAAABbm9uZQAAAAAAAAABAAABlwAAAAdzc2gtcn
NhAAAAAwEAAQAAAYEAuCCoxSR6xDCnsm98kqan1x1JF3mfZ6kZa+BoAHetQ/91F4EKTfmE
E+Xs8yVgLhn1YL0TvyVswMzy330eFJV/KEzef54V8yZo7jFcX+pQl0F6+BFRy+wsyLASV5
KxD/AtafdbvFLZFGTLC53k0FfT0VxokFmnTlIwRyxRJuNAWP9+fkAtbnfqkkixWqg0ZaLr
lFICYam6vb6iImNfuiGHZyQNHeTkOKZgAaMnQW6bYlRjnkxsNNxk1pj0sT3MUQdLrPCdyh
L8rXUqZ60NZPA6X82/hJNQJR+zVghXrGmTTLU7MAHN7rTdoq4bIQtdShuZZmd5igp50vVg
tCn4bRM2CFXl8m0P6gNDpR+VYH5f99MwdXyrDUAzusH7H6CyawRZZF8rFoqONc6HwTJ2h
YJw2uf85ltD3wR8XWzvnBlf2+U90Emhs01uEYNtNvhq7Gvz/TGI0wR0hEBmsznSns0jShT
cqvSnTMhHaXse3u2D+tbGoC3w0c0yjeX7Skhq63bAAAFiMnVC+zJlQvsAAAAB3NzaC1yc2
EAAAGBALggqMUKesQwp7JvfJKmp9cdSRd5n2epGWvgaAB3rUP/dReBCk35hBPL7PMLYC4Z
9WC9E78lbMDM8t9znhsVfyhM3n+eFfMma04xXMfquJTHevgRUcvSLMiwEleV8Q/wLWn3W1
Ky2RRkywud5DhX09FcaJBZp05SMEcsUSbjQFj/fn5ALW536pJIsVqoNGWi69XyAmGpur2+
opZjX7ohh2ckDR3k5DimYAGjJ0Fum2JUy55MbDTCZNaY9LE9zFEHS6zwncoZfK11KmetDW
fW0L/Nv4STUCUfs1YIV6xpk05V0zABze603aKuGyELQ0obmWZneYoKeTr1YLQp+G0TNghV
5fJtD+oDQ6UfLWB+X/fTMHV8qw1AM7rrB+x+gsmsEWWrfKxaKjjX0h8EydowCcNrn/OZbQ
98EfF1s75wZX9vLPThJobNNbhGDbTb4auxr8/0xiNMEdIRAZrM50p7NI0oU3KlbJ0zIR2l
7Ht7tg/rWxqAt8DnDso3l+0pIaut2wAAAAMBAAEAAAGAEgTUL1LGFtwCFUK2yK05gKiZjH
IRCPZx7+4qj10m3iAqR84PgZj49W+LVDIkqu5MZpaqT4rsjS0hYv+wCSimJH39SjTgxgZM
v36iK0hBcYhtXchoHLIzAcLFUL/yMtKYxyV3UT5uQwIoIq9lbaQerP7jlrjHWFDFP2y85k9
bqams6aEW EjKp8kKs/e/U5B3c9qBbCZ+dRyI7W32vDKvZsB0puZC4JrYe0nqpmRY968LD6
8Lty3WtyDNQ0IgI/s/BIK4wmzFM/drZH0LJYjzJssyvjaSf5XydPq0sK+z/0wRut1ev4+j
2hBuFqunZN0uq2nIz4LSSocLPtTZqu2PhbQgGJj80aXSH+TkKoLv+sG8d0+rrWtllkDJPX
YsWBmcWfd/Rj0Lnk0BSGu+00ne4IpK+7wAWN0Jwpw8MQkLRJkATay0rsGw3Bt7Bf70qnDA
gPFNfgckMfhWiORhwezgm5zEK50g4cCgwdCH2YQwQluRQHWWKkPat9XjXCxSj3N9D1BAAAA
wF2LTVT5VAvkqhJRe4KeT8RhydARmWdt/6YUY+liDnK/Bm4lhpeUrXJ2frX1sGeAty60ZL
LA31Y+kV9xgS4HN0T2aRTCXdfVJ4XmMCsiTxcRejTo92c3EIfD/ttbxkoLTsR/2tjkYje3
GbMOZpg3n0Rgtph0sjYfy5XyBBYNEg7GEJ6jSNBr9nA+wZILqVbuaDdn+FeVcgWSxFUyIC
xGZ0HketuIdv7EkperlJCckl0Ll6Z3i0jwlfFcMuZj98b1u/QAAAMEA5JNGvpj8WT4aQuM7
XME/N/m//8/sAb2DMHUWMy0ySSSNRDbM3pJKkja7nUp0CybwTYTrf/agLxIgdQAo71GpK7
ePRmsGu5+mrreNJKicGyER0IqCBhbWyljGDKFMJNGb2gk0Mu9XNZk9y3lRDMPRcfBMekmV
fAjvy5rgAqyf/PsKznyZE12eGosH+CkfVWXDVRXd/ho0dWIZqaC+w8nLso6WLKhptWz8ke
SghZBBAsJW42cyenvyIdIzpVicJpubAAAAWQDO0Coj/QwJLwX0d75KuUsfgI0Esq9vLSWL
Ds3fQGhnNMEJZfD9B/W8Xa7VCLfPHDItcDoXiSgj4dQnS1JeeVBBUHXLUlMkLmNLRNQjLD
0HSgyFYTPxl8t05ZAlFRnGEwe7y9RvNeXp9zPQC2v1FTVQ2RdALiWvR4fGyDu0ER4hYia/
WfqaBSBABkdhyWLiTbja/VncIHBZ04Bk1S9nwc0z6USyTXpTwpZIJw1074Tjk+8X3or8WC
XN158egNsB+sEAAAA0cnVkeUBsb2NhbgHvc3QBAgMEBQ==
-----END OPENSSH PRIVATE KEY-----
bandit13@bandit:~$ exit

```

Step 4: Connect to Bandit 14

From the folder containing the key, run:

```
ssh -i .\sshkey.private bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
```

If the key is accepted, you should enter:

bandit14@bandit:~\$

```
bandit13@bandit:~$ exit
logout
Connection to bandit.labs.overthewire.org closed.
PS C:\Users\YOKESHKANNA> notepad sshkey.private
PS C:\Users\YOKESHKANNA> icacls .\sshkey.private /inheritance:r
processed file: .\sshkey.private
Successfully processed 1 files; Failed processing 0 files
PS C:\Users\YOKESHKANNA> icacls .\sshkey.private /grant:r "$($env:USERNAME):(R)"
processed file: .\sshkey.private
Successfully processed 1 files; Failed processing 0 files
PS C:\Users\YOKESHKANNA> ssh -i .\sshkey.private bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org -p 2220
```

Step 5: Get the password

Once you are logged in as **bandit14**, run:

```
cat /etc/bandit_pass/bandit14
```

The output is the **password for Bandit Level 14**.

Then you can continue to **Level 14 → Level 15**.

```
backend: gibson-0
Load key ".\sshkey.private": invalid format
bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:
Permission denied, please try again.
bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:
Permission denied, please try again.
bandit14@bandit.labs.overthewire.org's password:
Connection closed by 51.20.162.29 port 2220
PS C:\Users\YOKESHKANNA> hAAAAAwEAAQAAAYEAuCCoxSR6xDCnsm98kqan1x1JF3mfZ6kZa+
```